

Weijia Zhang

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EDUCATION

Yale University <i>M.S. in Computer Science (Thesis Track with Full Scholarship)</i> University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC) <i>B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics</i>	Aug 2026 - May 2027 <i>Incoming Student</i> Aug 2022 - May 2026 <i>GPA: 3.7/4.0 (2025 Dean's List)</i>
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WORK EXPERIENCE

Microsoft, Microsoft Research Asia (MSRA) <i>Research Intern</i> - Worked on VLM/LLM Agent research to improve Microsoft Excel Copilot capabilities - Built TextAnalysisSFT data pipeline for SFT data generation for the new TextAnalysis API in Excel Copilot: Kaggle mining (2000+ real samples) → heavy-text filtering → query & Office.js code generation → SheetEngine validation; delivered dataset improved Office Script code generation accuracy by 75%	July 2025 – Sep 2025
Reborn Network <i>AI Engineer</i> - Developed a role-playing agent Unity VR Game enabling agents interaction through text/voice/VR actions in real time (< 1s latency) - Introduced RAG/vector database to strengthen long-term agent memory, improving dialogue coherence score from 2/5 to 4/5 - Designed a reusable "character card" framework, enabling UGC ecosystem and reducing character persona configuration time by 300%	May 2023 – July 2023
Tencent <i>Software Engineer, Wechat Group</i> - Developed a cross-platform (Android & iOS) hardware performance analysis tool for WeChat Mini Programs, supporting 200+ partner teams in identifying performance bottlenecks - Built Unity Mono Memory Profiler that discovered 40+ hidden memory allocation points, reducing memory-leak-related crash rate by 120%	Aug 2024 – Sep 2024

PUBLICATIONS (100+ CITATION)

Weijia Zhang , Zijia Liu, Tianyi Zhang, Ruiqi Chen, Lian Zhang, Haoru Li, Haoqi Chen, Jiaxuan You. "How Much Vision Does Multimodal Reasoning Need? Vision-Stripping for Multimodal Benchmarks" <i>Under review at NeurIPS 2026</i>
Weijia Zhang , Ruiqi Chen, Yunze Xiao, Weihao Xuan. "Every Act Has Its Price: Compressed Moral Composition in Frontier LLMs" <i>Under review at EMNLP 2026</i>
Weijia Zhang* , Zijia Liu*, Haoru Li*, Haoqi Chen*, Jiaxuan You. "SeeingEye: Agentic Information Flow Unlocks Multimodal Reasoning in Text-only LLMs." <i>arXiv preprint arxiv:2510.25092 Under review at EMNLP 2026</i>
Gordon Dai*, Weijia Zhang* , Jinhan Li, Siqi Yang, Srihas Rao, Arthur Caetano, Misha Sra. "Artificial Leviathan: Exploring Social Evolution of LLM Agents Through the Lens of Hobbesian Social Contract Theory." <i>The First Workshop on AI Behavioral Science, ACM SIGKDD 2024</i>
Miaomiao Li, Hao Chen, Yang Wang, Tingyuan Zhu, Weijia Zhang , Kaijie Zhu, Kam-Fai Wong, Jindong Wang. "Understanding and Mitigating the Bias Inheritance in LLM-based Data Augmentation on Downstream Tasks." <i>ACL 2026. Oral</i>
Kunlun Zhu, Zijia Liu, Bingxuan Li, Muxin Tian, Yingxuan Yang, Jiaxun Zhang, Pengrui Han, Qipeng Xie, Fuyang Cui, Weijia Zhang , Xiaoteng Ma, Xiaodong Yu, Gowtham Ramesh, Jialian Wu, Zicheng Liu, Pan Lu, James Zou, Jiaxuan You. "Where LLM Agents Fail and How They Can Learn From Failures." <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.25370</i> .

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

OpenManus & OpenManus-RL (Researcher, GitHub 60k+ Stars) GitHub - Collaborated with the official OpenManus team as a core contributor to OpenManus-RL, the follow-up project of OpenManus; the open-source ecosystem has accumulated 60,000+ GitHub stars - Implemented a ReAct-style reasoning architecture (<i>Think</i> → <i>Act</i> → <i>Tool-use</i>) and multi-agent collaboration workflows; built an MCP-based tool-library framework for automated tool invocation and output processing - Constructed high-quality SFT datasets for agent benchmarks including AlfWorld and WebShop; designed step-level reward signals to improve agent planning and memory capabilities	Jan 2025 – Jul 2025
GUIAgentDebugger (First Author / Lead) - Designed a GUI-agent error taxonomy with 4 major categories and 29 subtypes, covering perception, interaction localization, task reasoning, and external system failures across mainstream OSWorld/CUA scenarios - Built a self-evolving VLM-agent debugging framework that automatically identifies root causes from failed trajectories, distills them into reusable debugging skills, and enables agents to learn autonomously from historical failures - Designed a dual-layer memory architecture with episodic and semantic memory, together with an intent-aware RAG retrieval mechanism that injects skills from similar-intent trajectories to improve diagnosis and re-rollout accuracy	Jan 2026 – Present

ACTIVITIES & AWARDS

C.W. Gear Outstanding Undergraduate Student (2 people per year)	May 2026
UIUC Dean's List	2025
RecSys 2025 Reviewer	Aug 2025
UIUC MechMania 28 AI Hackathon — 2nd Place	Sep 2022

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, C#, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL, Rust
Frameworks & Libraries: VERL, VLLM, LangGraph, LangChain, PyTorch, Tensorflow
AI Focus: SFT, Reinforcement Learning, Post-training, RAG, Agentic Agent, Machine Learning, Generative AI